SSC CGL 2019 Tier-I question paper with answers

9 March 2020 · Shift 2

48 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 52 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20200710213341/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Final_Answer_key%20cgle19t1.pdf

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1
How many medals did India win in the 2012 Summer Olympics?

(A) 6 **(B)** 5
(C) 3 **(D)** 4

Q.2
What is the rank of India in the Human Development Index 2019?

(A) 128th **(B)** 130th
(C) 89th **(D)** 129th

Q.3
Constantan is an alloy of copper and _____.

(A) aluminium **(B)** iron
(C) nickel **(D)** tin

Q.4
Who among the following was the mascot of the Men's Hockey World Cup held at Bhubaneswar in 2018?

(A) Borobi **(B)** Millie
(C) Shera **(D)** Turtle Olly

Q.5
The rating for a fuse used in a household electric circuit is provided on the basis of:

(A) voltage **(B)** resistance
(C) power **(D)** current

Q.6
What is the rank of India in the Global Peace Index 2019?

(A) 141 **(B)** 144
(C) 142 **(D)** 143

Q.7
Which of the following is the lowermost layer of the Atmosphere?

(A) Troposphere **(B)** Thermosphere
(C) Exosphere **(D)** Mesosphere

Q.8
Who among the following is the Chief Minister of Mizoram as on November 2019?

(A) Conrad Kongkal Sangma **(B)** Neiphiu Rio
(C) Laldenga **(D)** PU Zoramthanga

Q.9
Which of the following ministries is NOT associated with the initiative of Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao Scheme?

(A) Ministry of Health and Family Welfare **(B)** Ministry of Women and Child Development
(C) Ministry of Human Resource Development **(D)** Ministry of Rural Development

Q.10
In July 2019, which of the following schemes was launched to accelerate water harvesting and conservation measures?

(A) Jal Bachao Abhiyan
(B) Jal Vikas Abhiyan
(C) Jal Shakti Abhiyan
(D) Jal hi dhan hai Abhiyan

Q.11
Who of the following authored the book 'Revolution 2020'?

(A) Arvind Kejriwal
(B) Devdutt Pattnaik
(C) Rupa Pai
(D) Chetan Bhagat

Q.12
Under which Amendment to the Constitution of India was Goods and Services Tax imposed?

(A) 99th
(B) 101st
(C) 97th
(D) 103rd

Q.13
Which of the following rivers was known as Purushni in the Vedic period?

(A) Chenab
(B) Beas
(C) Ravi
(D) Sutlej

Q.14
In 2019, IIT-Madras launched the country's first indigenously designed standing wheelchair named as:

(A) Optimist
(B) Marathon
(C) Awake
(D) Arise

Q.15
In which state is the festival of Uttarayan uniquely celebrated?

(A) Gujarat
(B) Kerala
(C) Jharkhand
(D) Uttar Pradesh

Q.16
Who among the following is NOT a recipient of the 2019 Mother Teresa Memorial Awards for Social Justice?

(A) Kailash Satyarthi
(B) Ajeet Singh
(C) Medha Patkar
(D) Priti Patkar

Q.17
What does 'C' stand for in ITCZ?

(A) Constant
(B) Convergence
(C) Circulation
(D) Convection

Q.18
Which tales are related with the painting and sculptures of the Ajanta caves?

(A) Panchatantra Tales
(B) Pentamerone Tales
(C) Jataka Tales
(D) Hitopadesha Tales

Q.19
Which of the following states does NOT share its boundary with Nepal?

(A) Uttar Pradesh
(B) Assam
(C) West Bengal
(D) Bihar

Q.20
Which among the following is a non-biodegradable waste?

(A) Plastic
(B) Flowers
(C) Vegetables
(D) Dead animals

Q.21
Who signed the treaty of Alinagar with the British?

(A) Mir Qasim
(B) Alivardi Khan
(C) Siraj-ud-Daula
(D) Mir Jafar

Q.22
Who among the following initiated 'Din-i-Ilahi'?

(A) Akbar
(B) Humayun
(C) Babur
(D) Jahangir

Q.23
Which of the following events did NOT occur in 1919?

(A) Rowlatt Act was passed
(B) Montague Chelmsford Reform was announced
(C) Jallianwala Bagh tragedy took place
(D) Partition of Bengal took place

Q.25
'Pedology' is the science of:

(A) ground water
(B) soil
(C) childhood illness
(D) skin disease

English Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1
Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. Having something more than required

(A) Surplus
(B) Surcharge
(C) Surroundings
(D) Surrogate

Q.2
In the sentence identify the segment which contains the grammatical error. We must get this post send as soon as possible.

(A) this post
(B) We must get
(C) soon as possible
(D) send as

Q.3
Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select No improvement. I was sitting at home doing nothing when I “had heard” that song again.

(A) heard
(B) has heard
(C) hears
(D) No improvement

Q.4
Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options pick the one that gives their correct order. A. They also visit ailing friends and relatives, or attend to personal matters even during office hours. B. Once in office, they receive friends and relatives who call them any time without prior appointment. C. We can frequently find a large number of people sitting here and there and doing nothing. D. Even those who are employed often come late to office and leave early unless they are forced to be punctual.

(A) ABCD
(B) CDBA
(C) ACDB
(D) DCAB

Q.5
Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Abort

(A) Begin
(B) Hate
(C) Continue
(D) End

Q.6

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. “What are you going to call the puppy, Jane?” the boy asked.

(A) The boy told Jane what she was going to call her puppy.

(B) Jane asked the boy what is he going to call the puppy.

(C) The boy asked Jane what she was going to call the puppy.

(D) The boy wondered what Jane were going to call the puppy.

Q.7

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. In a way, adult education is an educational movement through the medium (1)_____ village schools. In the beginning, the (2)_____ were suspicious. It was hard to persuade (3)_____ to realise that they were really getting something (4)_____ the schools. They were not at all sure that they wanted their (5)_____ to leave their homes.

Select the most appropriate option for the blank numbered 1.

(A) by

(B) from

(C) in

(D) of

Q.8

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. In a way, adult education is an educational movement through the medium (1)_____ village schools. In the beginning, the (2)_____ were suspicious. It was hard to persuade (3)_____ to realise that they were really getting something (4)_____ the schools. They were not at all sure that they wanted their (5)_____ to leave their homes.

Select the most appropriate option for the blank numbered 2.

(A) villagers

(B) children

(C) politicians

(D) officers

Q.9

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. In a way, adult education is an educational movement through the medium (1)_____ village schools. In the beginning, the (2)_____ were suspicious. It was hard to persuade (3)_____ to realise that they were really getting something (4)_____ the schools. They were not at all sure that they wanted their (5)_____ to leave their homes.

Select the most appropriate option for the blank numbered 3.

(A) us

(B) them

(C) they

(D) him

Q.10

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. In a way, adult education is an educational movement through the medium (1)_____ village schools. In the beginning, the (2)_____ were suspicious. It was hard to persuade (3)_____ to realise that they were really getting something (4)_____ the schools. They were not at all sure that they wanted their (5)_____ to leave their homes.

Select the most appropriate option for the blank numbered 4.

(A) for

(B) by

(C) to

(D) from

Q.11

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. In a way, adult education is an educational movement through the medium (1)_____ village schools. In the beginning, the (2)_____ were suspicious. It was hard to persuade (3)_____ to realise that they were really getting something (4)_____ the schools. They were not at all sure that they wanted their (5)_____ to leave their homes.

Select the most appropriate option for the blank numbered 5.

(A) teachers
(B) villagers
(C) children
(D) parents

Q.12

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Shining
(B) Soldier
(C) Guidence
(D) Beginning

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select No improvement. One evening, when father was coming home from work, I “played” in the front garden.

(A) play
(B) am playing
(C) No improvement
(D) was playing

Q.14

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options pick the one that gives their correct order. A. Accommodation and food were given free. B. This was held in a hostel for poor students built by a philanthropist. C. A few years ago, I was the chief guest at a small function. D. But the inmates of the hostel had to bear other expenses like clothing and toiletries.

(A) BCDA
(B) CBAD
(C) BCAD
(D) ABCD

Q.15

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Emerge

(A) Disappear
(B) Appear
(C) Announce
(D) Surface

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Mellow

(A) Shiny
(B) Medium
(C) Hard
(D) Soft

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Suzerainty is having political control over a _____ state.

(A) dependent
(B) democratic
(C) backward
(D) unified

Q.19

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. My cousin’s study on the reading habits of school children across three states has been recognised as a _____ piece of research.

(A) useless
(B) proud
(C) pioneering
(D) negligent

Q.20

In the sentence identify the segment which contains the grammatical error. Sita has no taste in classical dance.

(A) Sita has
(B) in
(C) classical dance
(D) no taste

Q.21

Select the most appropriate meaning of the following idiom. Blind alley

(A) A person who comes to meet occasionally

(B) A situation in which no further progress can be made

(C) A state of deep thought

(D) Taking first step after somebody's approach

Q.22

Select the most appropriate meaning of the following idiom. The acid test

(A) A critical situation or crisis

(B) An unpleasant or offensive test

(C) Throwing acid on someone's face

(D) A fact, event or situation that proves something

Q.23

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Exceed

(A) Decrease

(B) Surpass

(C) Decline

(D) Improve

Q.24

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. Anger about an unfair situation or about someone's unfair behaviour

(A) Indigenisation

(B) Indignation

(C) Indulgence

(D) Induction

Q.25

Select the correct passive form of the given sentence. The commander ordered his soldiers to move forward and attack the enemy camps.

(A) The commander was ordered by his soldiers to move forward and attack the enemy camps.

(B) The commander ordered his soldiers to be moved forward and attacked the enemy camps.

(C) The soldiers were ordered by their commander to move forward and attack the enemy camps.

(D) His soldiers were ordered by the commander to be moved forward and attacked the enemy camps.

Answer key

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.25 **(B)**

English Comprehension

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(C)**
Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(C)**

Explanations

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) 6

India won 6 medals at the London 2012 Olympics: 2 silver and 4 bronze.

Q.2 · Answer (D) 129th

In UNDP's Human Development Report 2019, released in December 2019, India ranked 129th of 189 countries, up from 130th.

Q.3 · Answer (C) nickel

Constantan is an alloy of about 55% copper and 45% nickel; its resistance hardly changes with temperature, so it is used in precision resistors, and it is also used in thermocouples.

Q.4 · Answer (D) Turtle Olly

The mascot of the 2018 Men's Hockey World Cup in Bhubaneswar was Olly, an olive ridley turtle. Borobi was the mascot of the 2018 Commonwealth Games and Shera of the 2010 Commonwealth Games.

Q.5 · Answer (D) current

A fuse is rated by the largest current it can carry, in amperes (for example 5 A or 15 A); a larger current melts its wire and breaks the circuit.

Q.6 · Answer (A) 141

In the Global Peace Index 2019, published in June 2019 by the Institute for Economics and Peace, India ranked 141st of 163 countries.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Troposphere

The troposphere, where weather occurs, is the lowest layer of the atmosphere; above it come the stratosphere, mesosphere, thermosphere and exosphere.

Q.8 · Answer (D) PU Zoramthanga

Zoramthanga ('Pu' is a Mizo title of respect) of the Mizo National Front became Chief Minister of Mizoram in December 2018, so he held the office in November 2019. Conrad Sangma was Chief Minister of Meghalaya and Neiphiu Rio of Nagaland; Laldenga, who led Mizoram when it became a state in 1987, died in 1990.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Ministry of Rural Development

Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao was launched in 2015 as a joint initiative of the Ministries of Women and Child Development, Health and Family Welfare, and Human Resource Development; the Ministry of Rural Development had no part in it.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Jal Shakti Abhiyan

The Jal Shakti Abhiyan, launched in July 2019, was a campaign for water conservation and rainwater harvesting in the country's water-stressed districts.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Chetan Bhagat

'Revolution 2020' (2011) is a novel by Chetan Bhagat.

Q.12 · Answer (B) 101st

GST was brought in by the Constitution (One Hundred and First Amendment) Act, 2016, which inserted Article 246A.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Ravi

In the Rigveda the Ravi is called the Parushni (Purushni); the Chenab was the Asikni, the Beas the Vipas and the Sutlej the Shutudri.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Arise

Arise, launched by IIT-Madras in November 2019, lets a wheelchair user move between sitting and standing without help.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Gujarat

Uttarayan, Gujarat's name for Makar Sankranti, is celebrated there with kite flying, including the International Kite Festival at Ahmedabad.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Medha Patkar

The 2019 Mother Teresa Memorial Awards, on the theme of combating modern forms of slavery, went to campaigners against child labour and trafficking, among them Kailash Satyarthi, Ajeet Singh and Priti Patkar of Prerana. Medha Patkar, of the Narmada Bachao Andolan, was not among them.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Convergence
ITCZ stands for the Inter-Tropical Convergence Zone, the low-pressure belt near the equator where the trade winds of the two hemispheres converge.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Jataka Tales
The paintings and sculptures of Ajanta illustrate the Jataka tales, stories of the Buddha's previous births.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Assam
Nepal borders five Indian states: Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, West Bengal and Sikkim. Assam does not touch it.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Plastic
Plastic is not broken down by microorganisms, so it is non-biodegradable; flowers, vegetables and dead animals decompose.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Siraj-ud-Daula
Siraj-ud-Daula, Nawab of Bengal, signed the Treaty of Alinagar with the East India Company in February 1757, after Clive retook Calcutta, which the Nawab had renamed Alinagar.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Akbar
Akbar started the Din-i-Ilahi in 1582, a path that drew on several religions.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Partition of Bengal took place
The Partition of Bengal took place in 1905 (and was annulled in 1911). The Rowlatt Act was passed and the Jallianwala Bagh massacre took place in 1919, and the Montagu-Chelmsford reforms were enacted by the Government of India Act, 1919.

Q.25 · Answer (B) soil
Pedology (from the Greek 'pedon', soil) is the study of soils: how they form, their properties and their classification.

English Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (A) Surplus
A 'surplus' is an amount more than is needed. A surcharge is an extra charge, and a surrogate a substitute.

Q.2 · Answer (D) send as
After 'get' and its object, a passive sense needs the past participle: 'get this post sent as soon as possible'.

Q.3 · Answer (A) heard
An action that interrupts one in progress takes the simple past: 'I was sitting … when I heard that song again.' The past perfect would put the hearing before the sitting.

Q.4 · Answer (B) CDBA
C introduces the people doing nothing, D turns to those who are employed, B says what they do once in office and A, with 'also', adds more: CDBA.

Q.5 · Answer (D) End
To 'abort' something is to end it before it is finished.

Q.6 · Answer (C) The boy asked Jane what she was going to call the puppy.
The question is reported with 'asked Jane', 'you are' becomes 'she was', and the word order becomes that of a statement.

Q.7 · Answer (D) of
The fixed phrase is 'through the medium of', meaning by means of: 'through the medium of village schools'.

Q.8 · Answer (A) villagers
The schools were for the village adults, so it was the 'villagers' who were suspicious at first; the passage goes on to speak of their children.

Q.9 · Answer (B) them
'Persuade' takes an object, and the pronoun for the villagers is 'them'.

Q.10 · Answer (D) from
One gets something 'from' a source: 'getting something from the schools'.

Q.11 · Answer (C) children
The villagers were not sure they wanted their 'children' to leave home.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Guidence
The correct spelling is 'guidance'.

Q.13 · Answer (D) was playing
Two actions in progress at the same time in the past both take the past continuous: 'when father was coming home from work, I was playing in the front garden'.

Q.14 · Answer (B) CBAD
C sets the scene, B says where the function was held, A says what the hostel gave free and D, with 'But', what the inmates still had to pay for: CBAD.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Disappear
To 'emerge' is to come into view; its opposite is to 'disappear'.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Hard
'Mellow' means soft and gentle; its opposite is 'hard'. 'Soft' is a synonym.

Q.18 · Answer (A) dependent
Suzerainty is a dominant state's control over a 'dependent' state, which usually keeps its own internal government.

Q.19 · Answer (C) pioneering
A study recognised for breaking new ground is 'pioneering'.

Q.20 · Answer (B) in
SSC's key gives 'in': for a liking for something, 'taste' takes 'for', as in 'Sita has no taste for classical dance'. 'Taste in' is also used, of judgement in matters of style ('good taste in clothes'), so the sentence can be defended, but there is no 'No error' option and none of the other parts could be at fault.

Q.21 · Answer (B) A situation in which no further progress can be made
A 'blind alley' is literally a dead end: a course of action that leads nowhere.

Q.22 · Answer (D) A fact, event or situation that proves something
The 'acid test' is a decisive test that proves the worth or truth of something, from the use of acid to test gold.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Surpass
To 'exceed' is to go beyond: to 'surpass'.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Indignation
'Indignation' is anger at unfair treatment. 'Indulgence' is giving way to one's desires, and 'induction' a formal introduction or a kind of reasoning.

Q.25 · Answer (C) The soldiers were ordered by their commander to move forward and attack the enemy camps.
The object 'his soldiers' becomes the subject and 'ordered' becomes 'were ordered'; the infinitives 'to move forward and attack' stay active.

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